

Question:

A 60-year-old woman is brought to the emergency department because of altered mental status for 2 hours. She and her husband were at the grocery store when she suddenly could not remember why she was there or how she got there. She has not had any head trauma. She has a history of depression and migraines. She does not smoke and drinks a glass of wine each night with dinner. She takes fluoxetine daily. She appears distressed and anxious. Her vital signs are within normal limits. She is fully alert and oriented to self and place but not to time. Every few minutes she asks how she got to the emergency department. She is able to follow commands and sustain attention. She recalls 3/3 objects immediately and recalls 0/3 objects at 5 minutes. The remainder of the neurological exam shows no abnormalities. Which of the following is the most likely diagnosis?

Answer Choices:

- A. Transient global amnesia
- B. Depersonalization/derealization disorder
- C. Seizure
- D. Migraine

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>
The patient's symptoms of sudden onset of confusion, disorientation to time, and memory loss, especially the inability to recall recent events, suggest a condition that affects the temporal lobe, which is responsible for memory formation and spatial navigation. The patient's history of migraines and depression, along with the absence of head trauma, makes seizure a strong possibility. Seizures can cause transient global amnesia, especially if they affect the temporal lobe. The patient's ability to recall 3 / 3 objects immediately and 0 / 3 objects at 5 minutes also suggests a transient memory issue, which is consistent with seizure activity. The patient's normal vital signs and lack of other neurological abnormalities make other conditions less likely. </think><answer> C. Seizure </answer>

